

LECTURE NO 15: *Successful Entrepreneur Stories*

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ORGANIZATION OF LECTURE

1. John Paul DeJoria.
2. Jan Koum.
3. Howard Schultz.
4. Oprah Winfrey.
5. Do Won Chang.
6. Ralph Lauren.
7. Steve Jobs and Steve Wozniak.
8. Sam Walton.
9. Wahaj Us Siraj.
10. Shahzad Roy.

1. John Paul DeJoria (1/2)

- Entrepreneur John DeJoria is entirely self-made. He is most well known as the founder of the Paul Mitchell line of hair-care products. But his early life was not characterized by riches: he started his career as a truck driver, janitor and even sold Christmas cards door-to-door. He was fired from his first job in haircare — while working for Redken Laboratories. Then, in 1980, he formed John Paul Mitchell Systems with hairdresser Paul Mitchell, with a loan of just \$700. He is now worth \$3.1 billion!



1. John Paul DeJoria (2/2)

- His thoughts on success? DeJoria once said, *“The biggest hurdle is rejection. Any business you start, be ready for it. The difference between successful people and unsuccessful people is the successful people do all the things the unsuccessful people don’t want to do. When 10 doors are slammed in your face, go to door number 11 enthusiastically, with a smile on your face.”*

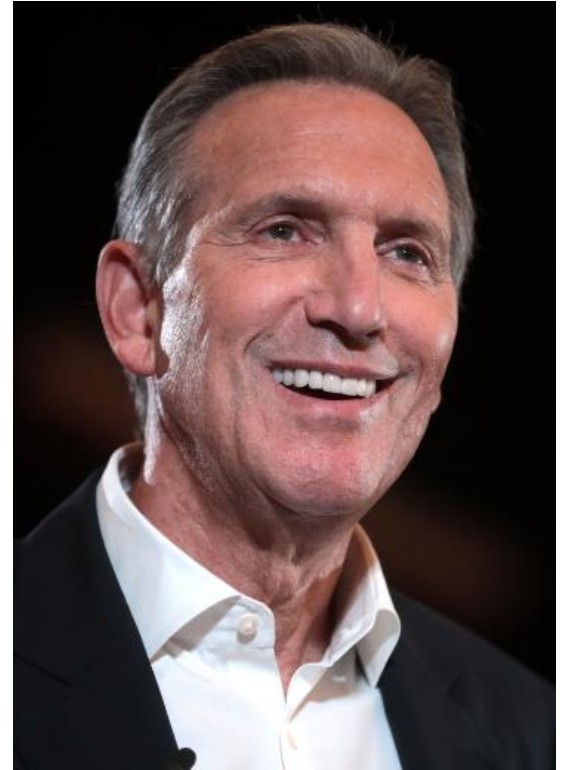
2. Jan Koum

- Could you live without WhatsApp? No, we couldn't either. Thankfully Jan Koum, a Ukrainian emigrant to the USA, invented the communication app in 2009. After being born into poverty, Koum began learning about computers. At 18, he already had high-level skills, and in 1997, he began working for Yahoo! as an infrastructure engineer. He launched WhatsApp to great acclaim after buying his first smartphone and having the idea for the product, which allows people to send messages between mobile phones via the web, regardless of what country they are in. Facebook bought the app for a staggering \$19 billion. His top tip? *"Do one thing, and do it well"*.



3. Howard Schultz (1/2)

- Starbucks founder Howard Schultz may be synonymous with entrepreneurial success, but life wasn't always so rosy. His family didn't have much money and he grew up in a housing estate. He paid for college with government loans and money earned from part-time jobs. He was also the first person in his family to go to college. It was while working for a coffee company that Schultz first came into contact with Starbucks brand. He visited a branch of the new company in Seattle. Soon after, he joined the company as marketing director.



3. Howard Schultz (2/2)

- In 1985, Schultz left Starbucks and decided to open his own coffee house. He raised the \$500,000 he needed to open the first store and started his business. Two years later, the original Starbucks management decided to sell its retail unit to Schultz and Starbucks as we know it today was born. Schultz is now worth in excess of \$3.2 billion — not bad for an empire that he dreamed up over an afternoon cup of coffee!
- His experiences have led him to develop a philosophical approach to life. “*I believe life is a series of near-misses,*” he once said in a speech. “A lot of what we ascribe to luck is not luck at all. It’s seizing the day and accepting responsibility for your future. It’s seeing what other people don’t see and pursuing that vision.”

4. Oprah Winfrey (1/2)

- The powerful woman we know today as a talk-show host, writer, campaigner, Golden Globe winner and global icon was actually born into poverty in rural Mississippi and raised in inner-city Milwaukee. Yet she didn't let her past define her future. After a troubled childhood, Winfrey landed a job in radio while still in high school. By 19, she was a co-anchor for the local evening news. Soon after, she became a daytime talk-show host and went on to launch her own production company. By 32 years-old, Winfrey was a millionaire. By 2000, she had a net worth of \$800 million, making Winfrey the richest African American of the 20th century. By 2008, her yearly income had increased to \$275 million. By 2023, Forbes claimed that Winfrey had a net worth in excess of 2.8 billion dollars. The reason she did so well? Because she aligned her work with her passion.



4. Oprah Winfrey (2/2)

- In a speech at the Golden Globes, Oprah explained, *“The single greatest wisdom I think I’ve ever received is that the key to fulfillment, success, happiness, contentment in life is when you align your personality with what your soul actually came to do. I believe everyone has a soul and their own personal spiritual energy. When you use your personality to serve whatever that thing is, you can’t help but be successful.”*.

5. Do Won Chang (1/2)

- Won Chang might not be a household name, but his fashion chain Forever 21 certainly is. Before launching the retail empire in 1984, Won Chang worked as a janitor, at a gas station and in a coffee shop when he first moved to America from South Korea. The first store he opened with his wife was 900 square feet in LA, and they opened with only \$11,000 in savings, plunging it all into the business. At first the shop was called Fashion 21 and customers mainly came from the Korean American community. But soon the customer base expanded and after a name change to Forever 21, the business flew.

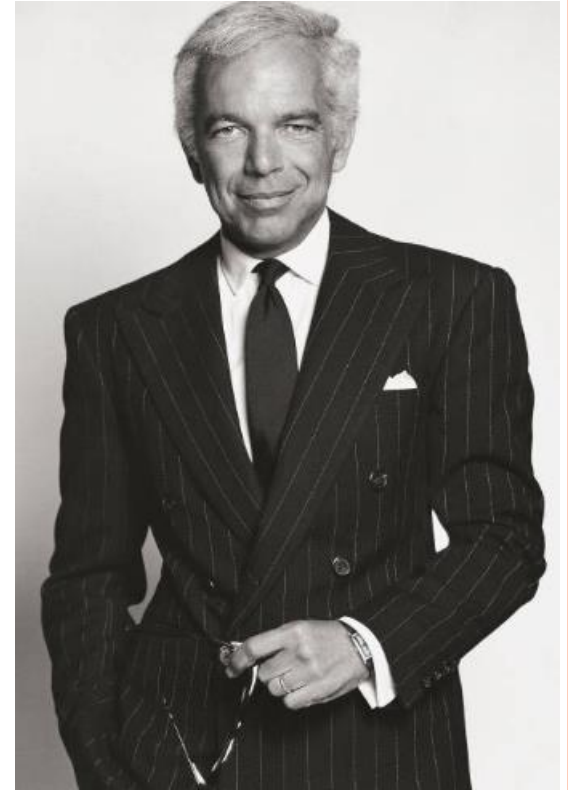


5. Do Won Chang (2/2)

- It's now an international, 790-store empire and Do Won Chang is said to be worth \$3.2 billion. His top tip? *Never forget where you come from.* Speaking to the LA Times, Won Chang said: *“Forever 21 gives hope and inspiration to people who come here with almost nothing. The fact that immigrants coming to America, much like I did, can come into a Forever 21 and know that all of this was started by a simple Korean immigrant with a dream.”*

6. Ralph Lauren (1/2)

- Household name and fashion industry titan Ralph Lauren graduated high school in the Bronx, New York, but later dropped out of college to join the US Army. He was working as a sales assistant at US menswear store Brooks Brothers when he began to wonder if men were ready for something more colorful, specifically when it came to ties. In 1967, he decided to try his hand at running his own business and he started selling ties. In his first year of trading, he sold \$500,000 worth of merchandise. He started Polo the next year.

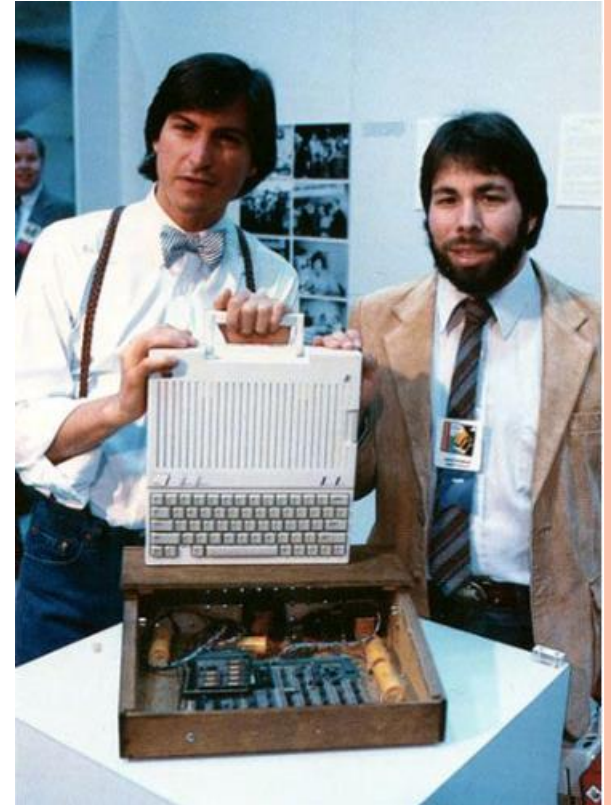


6. Ralph Lauren (2/2)

- The Ralph Lauren Corporation is now a global multibillion-dollar enterprise and Lauren is a household name, counting A-list models and actors as close friends. As of 2018, Forbes estimates his wealth to be \$7.2 billion, which makes Ralph Lauren the 91st richest person in America. His advice to would-be entrepreneurs? “*You have to create something from nothing,*” and, “*The world is open to us, and each day is an occasion to reinvent ourselves.*”

7. Steve Jobs and Steve Wozniak (1/2)

- The story of Steve Jobs and Steve Wozniak starting Apple Computers in a garage in Los Altos, California, is well-known. The pair had pulled-out from their respective college courses and began developing consumer computer devices in Jobs' parents garage in California. But before this, Steve worked an assortment of low-paid jobs, including one when he was 13, for Hewlett Packard. After developing a couple different models with Wozniak, the pair knew they would need more financing. So Jobs had to find a guarantor to get a bank loan for \$250,000. But he more than succeeded.



7. Steve Jobs and Steve Wozniak (2/2)

- When Steve died, in 2011, he was said to be worth \$10.2 billion. He'd built this up over time. He had a million dollars to his name in 1978, when he was just 23. As for his legacy? Well, it's in our pockets, on our screens, at the cinema in the 2015 film Steve Jobs, and all around us.
- His advice to you? Persevere when times get tough. *"Sometimes life is going to hit you in the head with a brick. Don't lose faith,"* he is quoted as saying.

8. Sam Walton (1/2)

- Founder of Walmart, one of the biggest superstores in the USA, Sam Walton, had just returned to private life after serving in the US army during World War II, when he opened his first retail store in 1945. His father-in-law lent him \$25,000 which was used to buy his first store, and thankfully he became an immediate success. By the mid-1970s, Walmart was valued at more than \$176 million. Today, it has more than 11,000 stores across the globe and has an operating income of more than \$21 billion in 2019.



8. Sam Walton (2/2)

- Walton's tips for success? These are explained in detail in his book, *Made In America*, but one of his key principles is to follow your own path, not the path followed by others. "Ignore the conventional wisdom," he says here. *"If everybody else is doing it one way, there's a good chance you can find your niche by going in exactly the opposite direction."*

9. Wahaj Us Siraj



- Wahaj Us Siraj is the CEO and Co-Founder of **Nayatel**, a leading fiber-to-the-home (FTTH) service provider in Pakistan. Nayatel has revolutionized the internet and communication landscape in Pakistan by providing high-speed and reliable connectivity to homes and businesses, under Wahaj's leadership. His entrepreneurial journey is a testament to the potential of the telecommunications industry in Pakistan.

10. Shahzad Roy

- Shahzad is not just a renowned musician but also an inspiring social entrepreneur. He founded the **Zindagi Trust**, a non-profit organization that works towards improving the quality of education in Pakistan's government schools. Through innovative initiatives and a dedicated team, Shahzad Roy is transforming the educational landscape of the country, providing a ray of hope for underprivileged children.



THANK YOU